

Tahar Meijs

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Experience

Deloitte – Amsterdam, The Netherlands

September 2020 – Present

Specialist lead / manager

- Built a neobank on AWS with Go, Lambda, and DynamoDB within 12 months that uses a serverless architecture to achieve low average operational costs and support high burst traffic. It also eliminated the need for an expensive Kubernetes cluster with JVM containers.
- Implemented a monitoring stack on CloudWatch to track Step Function performance and SQS queue loads.
- Designed event-driven serverless architecture using Lambda, EventBridge, and SQS.
- Coached and mentored junior engineers, guiding them from being on a performance improvement plan to promotion to the next level within two years.

Senior specialist / senior consultant

- Led an 8-person engineering team building an event-driven loan origination platform, integrating with a dozen external APIs and services, resulting in successful project delivery and 3 team member promotions.
- Built a corporate loan origination platform processing 50M+ euros in loans annually, reducing approval time from multiple weeks to days.
- Decomposed a distributed monolith application into a dozen domain-specific microservices, improving our team's velocity to deliver new tickets.

Specialist / consultant

- Built an event-driven retail loan origination platform for a large Dutch bank using Java and AWS, generating 7.5M+ euros in loans each year.
- Designed and built a custom debugging tool to resolve bugs in event-driven systems using Kafka, significantly speeding up incident resolution time and improved developer experience.
- Built an ETL pipeline processing 100k+ JSON Kafka events per hour, all transformed into SQL table entries, and uploaded to a datalake using FTP for audit purposes.

Analyst

- Contributed to a digital loan origination solution for a large Dutch bank that reduces the time it takes to apply for a loan from 6 weeks to 15 minutes by automating their offline processes.

Sumo Digital – Sheffield, United Kingdom

September 2019 – August 2020

Junior software engineer

- Built a real-time testing and video streaming dashboard processing over 10.000 test results daily using React, Node.js, and Websockets, reducing the QA feedback cycle from hours to minutes.
- Optimised PlayStation 5 resource packing algorithms in C++ by more efficiently allocating data chunks next to each other, reducing the game's overall size by 25%, allowing more data to be stored on Blu-ray discs.
- Developed a cross-platform video recording application for PlayStation 4/5 and PC with minimal overhead by asynchronously capturing the GPU's frame buffer.

Placement Programmer

- Designed and built a custom, cross-platform, testing framework for PC, PlayStation 4, and PlayStation 5 using C++ for PlayStation 5 launch title "Sackboy: A Big Adventure".
- Built a custom performance profiler for Unreal Engine 4 games with minimal overhead on the game's processes by intelligently batching operations.

Notable technical challenges

- Eliminated race conditions affecting roughly 1% of users in our KYC processes by implementing optimistic concurrency with self-healing, eliminating users stuck in limbo states.
- Introduced a custom-built debugger for distributed event-driven systems, improving developer debugging velocity by 50%. Bugs that would take two hours to resolve could now be resolved within the hour.
- Rearchitected core parts of our application to use transactional writes and centralised orchestration instead of tightly-coupled peer-to-peer orchestration patterns. This solved nearly all eventual consistency bugs.
- Asynchronously captured the GPU's frame buffer with minimal impact on the running processes. The game's logic and rendering took well over 14 milliseconds per frame, leaving less than 3 milliseconds to capture the frame buffer and (asynchronously) start H.264 encoding on NVIDIA's NVENC cores.

Skills

Backend technologies	Go, Java, Spring Boot, Node.js
Cloud and infrastructure	AWS (Lambda, Step Functions), Docker, Kubernetes, CDK, Terraform
Data and messaging	Kafka, DynamoDB, MongoDB, S3, SQS, EventBridge
Monitoring and observability	CloudWatch, DataDog
Architecture	Serverless, microservices, event-driven design, domain-driven design
Compliance	PII data masking, GDPR-compliant architecture, audit trails

Education

Breda University of Applied Sciences – BSc Creative Media and Game Technologies

2016 – 2020